



The gift came with conditions

DRAFT GIFT AGREEMENT / NOT SIGNED

1. Museum name

The Grant Larceny Meridian Museum

2. Collection decisions

Grant may veto future acquisitions

3. Museum director

Artie Ficial must resign within sixty days

Donor signature: _____

Grant Larceny has died at the gala after his private toast. His proposed gift agreement is still unsigned. These are the terms he intended to announce tonight.



An empty bottle in preparation



Object	The Velvet Widow poison bottle / acquisition lot 73
Label	CYANIDE / POISON
Found	Empty; original paper seal broken

I found the newly acquired poison bottle empty after the preparation-room tour. Its paper seal was broken. I locked the room and retained the bottle for examination. It had been brought out for the condition inspection of Grant's proposed exhibition centerpiece. Signed: Collections Assistant.



What happened to Grant's glass



6:39 / Still wrapped; seal intact



6:40 / Unwrapped; glass left unattended



6:44 / Covered; red seal applied



6:46 / Seal opened; punch poured

Initial lab finding

Cyanide inside Grant's glass

Shared punch and food

No cyanide detected

These are my setup photos. I stayed with the wrapped glass until 6:40. From 6:40 to 6:44, I was away from the table. After sealing the cover at 6:44, I watched it until I opened it to pour. I then watched Grant's glass until his 6:49 toast. The same glass was used throughout. Signed: Service Manager.



When the bottle was accessible



Recovered bottle / photographed after the tour

6:20 / room opens	Bottle full; original paper seal intact
6:28 / room closes	Bottle empty; cupboard locked
Other poison objects	No other bottles brought out or given to guests

The bottle was kept locked away before the tour. It was put on the visitor-side shelf when the room opened and locked away again at closing. Nobody obtained it outside those eight minutes. The laboratory matched material remaining in the bottle to residue inside Grant's glass.



Two different ways to approach preparation



WEST / return counter

Papers pass through a small slot

EAST / visitor doorway

Guests can enter and reach the shelf

The west return counter is outside a solid wall. Its small slot passes papers and support sleeves, not people. Staff did not pass the bottle or its contents through it. The east doorway is the only guest entrance to the shelves.



The glass, not the punch

Grant's glass / inside

CYANIDE DETECTED

Shared punch pitcher

NO CYANIDE DETECTED

Food samples

NO CYANIDE DETECTED

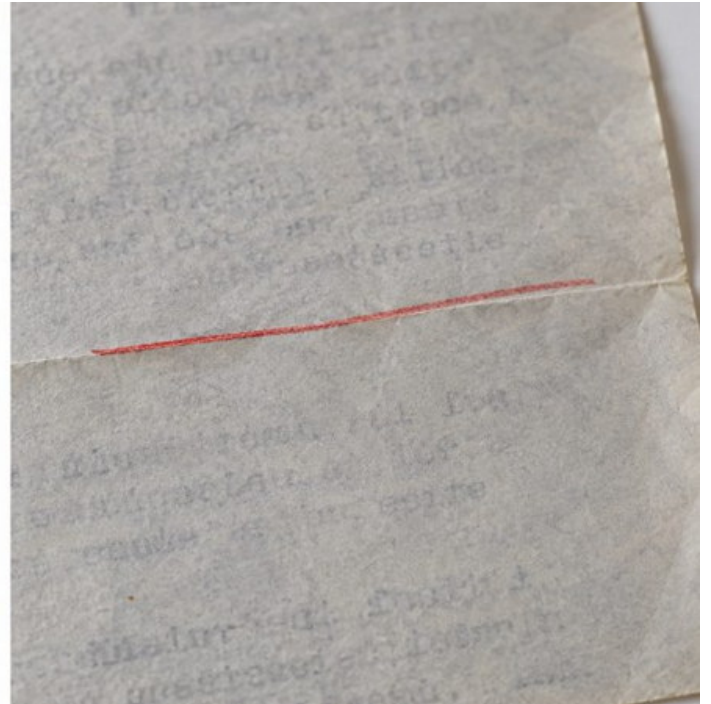
Acquired poison bottle

MIXTURE MATCHES GLASS RESIDUE

Cyanide was found on the inside of Grant's glass. Samples of the shared punch and food were clear. Material remaining in the acquired poison bottle matches the residue in the glass. The lab result identifies the poisoned object; the caterer's record establishes how it was handled.



Two details from the museum's records



Blue protective wrapping

Logo sticker across a closed seam

Blue cloth placemat

Logo embroidered into fabric

Raised RECEIVED stamp

First used at 6:45

The museum-logo sticker bridged the sealed plastic wrapping. The placemat's logo was sewn into cloth. They are different objects. The receiving desk first used its raised RECEIVED stamp at 6:45. Earlier working copies had flat red-pencil corrections, not that stamp.
